

Truth, the Sin Unto Death, and the Warning to Leave Milk Behind

I think truth is taking on the whole second person of the Godhead, the Logos. You cannot take it out of Him. You cannot take it away from Him. You cannot change who He is. He is true.

No wonder a man can feel safe wrapped up in His truth. God said it. The devil was reduced to eating the dust of the flesh.

I thought that was kind of funny. He was more subtle, deceptively deceitful, than the other beasts of the field. And I am thinking, "What other beasts? He is a serpent. Is it cows and dogs?"

But whoever the beasts were, he was more deceitful. He was deceptively deceitful. And he got reduced to eating the dust of the earth.

People say he used to have legs, and God took them off, so he had to crawl and eat the dust of the earth. Really, nobody says too much about it. They just say he was a serpent.

God used types, because how else would our mind understand what happened there? As a little kid in Sunday school, if I had gone, which I did twice, I think, I would have imagined Satan sitting there with a Coke, leaning over the fence, talking to Bossy the Cow.

"Hi, I am deceitfully more wise than you are."

"Really?"

"Yes. I have heard rumors that they are going to cut my legs off, and I will be eating the dust of the earth."

What it meant was that Satan was high class. He is the substitute for Jesus Christ. He thinks he is the god of this world. He thinks. He belonged to the cherubim class. Just one of them could deal with a Samaritan army, and he got reduced to eating the dust of the earth.

It means he was reduced to an operation on the level of the flesh. When is the last time your friend was thrown off a cliff by something he could not see, and not by another human? Satan really cannot do that. He can talk you into jumping. He can talk somebody else into throwing you off. But he was reduced to the level of the flesh, where he had to get you to do it.

So the more I find out about truth, the safer I feel. Satan has to use deception. He has always had his seat somewhere so he can work his evil, and he has always had people who would follow him. But the most powerful deception is when there is enough truth in it to deceive you.

We have been talking about the sin unto death. John said, "I do not say to pray for it."

The sin unto death is when Satan is able to deceive people by taking enough truth out of what they believe to eliminate Jesus as the Son of God, the One who provided redemption, the only way to the Father. No man comes to the Father but by Him.

The sin unto death is when people take on doctrines that eradicate salvation.

Those things are hardly ever mentioned. The unpardonable sin is mentioned, and people think, "Blasphemy of the Holy Spirit? I hope I have never done that."

You have not. It is a little more than we think. But church history has proved that if you do not get a foundation under you and do not find out who the Holy Spirit is, especially His teaching ministry above all, the church gets taken apart all the time.

So when we talk about truth, someone says, "I do not understand the unpardonable sin."

"Oh, I do not know what the sin unto death is."

"Oh yeah? Well, I do not even know what this means."

Remember when He told me on the born-again trail that most of the answers are in the verses we leave out? Obviously, the church world does not know too much, because they keep falling and falling.

There is a whole new fire for truth being kindled inside me. Hallelujah.

Peebles brought me several articles from what Carlton has been saying lately. The only reason we brought him up this morning is because I was examining the sin John said not to pray for, the sin unto death.

By the time John got to Second John, he said many deceivers had come into the world. He said that any man who teaches that Jesus Christ did not come in the flesh is antichrist. Any prophet who prophesies that He did not come is antichrist.

For hundreds of years that spirit has been in operation, because one meaning of the sin unto death is that the devil, using deception, wants to remove the foundation and the actual salvation of the cross from the message.

I want to know more truth. I want a better foundation than I have. I am not going to fall and tear down and destroy everything I have done. I am not going to do it.

John lived more than a hundred years, and he was beginning to battle this heavily by the time he went home. That is why in Second John he was able to say, "Many deceivers have come into the world." To him, antichrist meant preaching that Jesus did not come in the flesh and did not provide salvation for the entire world.

Paul had his battles with the Jews, the Judaizers. In Romans 8, he was having a hard time convincing the Jews that these swine-eating Gentiles had suddenly gotten in on the same inheritance, and God had become their Father without their keeping a single day of the law in

their lives.

Paul breaks it all down there. That is what Romans 8 is about.

By the time you get to Romans 7 and 8, he says, "I would not even have known covetousness, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet." A spiritually dead man, when that is his nature, does not know he is doing anything wrong. The law said to stop.

Paul was speaking hypothetically in the place of every Jew. The good he wanted to do, he could not do. Some of your teachers today say Romans 7 is a Christian having trouble with his flesh. It is not.

So when they get to the verse that says, "The good that I would I do not: but the evil which I would not, that I do," and then, "It is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me," they remove your righteousness from your acts of sin in the flesh. They say you are independently righteous of your works because it is no longer you, but sin that dwells in you.

But hypothetically speaking, Paul was in the place of every Jew who received the law and could not keep it. I do not mean the sacrificial law. I mean the heart of the law, the Ten Commandments. They could not keep it. That is why they had a Levitical priesthood and thousands of gallons of blood, just so God could work according to those commandments.

By the time Romans 7 graduates into Romans 8, he cries, "Who shall deliver me from the body of this death?" Then he answers his own question: "Jesus Christ our Lord."

Then he begins Romans 8:

There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh,
but after the Spirit.

The condemnation he was talking about was the Romans 7 condemnation: "The good I would, I cannot do; the evil I refuse, I end up doing. It is no longer I, but that sin nature. With my mind, I am trying to serve the law of God, but there is another law working in me. Who will deliver me from this death?"

He says, "Thank God, through Jesus Christ my Lord."

So the condemnation of Romans 7 was broken off because you now have a new nature and can fulfill the law without animal sacrifice.

The sin unto death is death for the man propagating it and for the people receiving it.

In Second John, John said anyone coming and preaching any other doctrine than what he had given them was not to be bid Godspeed. It makes you a partaker. In other words, you cannot just give them a hug and say, "Be blessed in your doctrine. Go your way."

We are called.

I did not know what He was asking of me when He said, "I want a revival of doctrine and truth, soundness of mind, and sanity."

I do not want a trinket revival. I want the kind of miracles that leave the church and go to the hospitals. He said, "I want such sanity with this that even the Einsteins of the world will have to stand up and say, 'This is so logical, so sane. There is a God. How do I find Him?'"

Come over here, sir. Hallelujah, Jesus.

He wants this. He wants it everywhere. It is no new doctrine. It is the one John keeps saying: "I have already told you these things, but I think I will tell them again. You really should love each other."

I like John.

Paul took on the Jews. Romans 8 was about why these swine-eating Gentiles could be saved. But when Hebrews began to be saved, the Hebrew scholars wanted to come and take salvation away from them. Paul defended that too, like a champion.

It is in that defense that you find the unpardonable sin. It is almost impossible to commit. Most of you in here would not even be able to do it.

Any turning you have done on God is usually because somebody hurt you. You got beat up. Sin grabbed you, took you on a spiral, and threw you away. The devil kept yelling, "It is God. He is mean to you." Then you get up and cuss Him out and think you have committed the unpardonable sin.

Go to the book of Hebrews. Hallelujah.

We can go back to the fourth chapter and sneak up on it, or we can just jump right into the middle of it. If you really wanted to sneak up, we could go way back.

Here are some more of the reports while you are finding the fifth chapter: "Nobody Goes to Hell: Minister Labeled a Heretic." One minister challenges the idea of hell and loses his congregation.

It does seem weird, does it not? People walk out on him because you believe in hell. But it is not weird. This will agree with the world. They will like it.

The article says, "Virtually every religion throughout human history has some notion of a horrible life after death. And though the threat of fire and brimstone is not preached as fervently in this age of reason, one man in Tulsa, Oklahoma, knows just how hard it is for modern believers and their religious institutions to let go of the medieval vision of hell."

Well, I am glad. I guess we are different from ancient ones.

Of course, nobody is fighting for somebody to spend eternity somewhere like that. That is the thing about the love of God. I got a dose of all I could handle. I shook and cried for days. Then a healing gift came for the emotion.

I caught one glimpse, and I wanted to run out and do just like Carlton did. I got to see you through His eyes for as long as I could take it. I think it was two or three hundred thousandths of a second. It was enough to reduce me to a blubbing, quivering mass of protoplasm on the floor.

You do not think I could understand some things about Him at that moment? The only thing I could understand was, "Everything is going to be okay."

I know more now. I heard Gary comment that you just want to run out and say, just like Carlton, "I am the new champion of the world. You are going to be okay."

"How about my son?"

"How about me?"

"What about me?"

When I pressed Him and pressed Him, which I did, because I know how to do that, He said more or less that I could not understand it right now, but if I kept growing, I would.

Then He showed me what He meant.

Take the attributes of God: sovereignty, righteousness, judgment, immutability, eternal life, love, omnipotence, omniscience, and omnipresence. Take them together, and that is what the essence of God is made of.

I know something about some of them. But when all the confines are gone, when I am in a new heaven and a new earth, and when I am in a glorified body, those things that are in His nature and also in mine will be heightened and come to fuller understanding.

Although you cannot understand it now, take the word "judgment." Judgment is derived from justice or justification. This means God is immutably unable to make a decision that is not just and justifiable.

I cannot understand everything about that now, but I will then, because that part of me will be more like Him. I can look at Him and know there was not one move He made that was not just.

Yet I can look on this side of glory and also see the other things He is, like love, which has all its fruit.

Peter tells you what you are developing when you worship God and have a communion flow of love between Him and you. You are the conduit that opens up. You are the reservoir that can take more and more. He cannot love you any more than He already does, but you can receive more of what He has already loved you with.

In worship, you build the fruit Peter talked about in the first chapter. He says:

Add to your faith virtue;
and to virtue knowledge;
and to knowledge temperance;
and to temperance patience;
and to patience godliness;
and to godliness brotherly kindness;
and to brotherly kindness charity.

He says we have been made partakers of His divine nature by these promises. You cannot keep fellowship without developing the virtue.

I know what He wants, which is still a little beyond what I know how to operate in. He took the sicknesses and pains of every unaccountable baby, every sinner who never had a fair chance, everything He redeemed us from. He knows how to come here and do those things. He is just looking for an avenue.

With the rest of those attributes, I will have more fullness when I get to heaven, that is for sure. But I am going to attain to some of them now. I am going to cross over while I am still here.

I want God to be able to do what He does best: enforce the redemption at the cost of His own Son. I am going over there. As far as I am concerned, I am already there, because I am going there.

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for. It is all the evidence I need of the thing I cannot yet see.

I do not care if He assigns all the planetary demons of hell in front of the door. He has already dealt with them. Numbers do not count. We are still going through the door.

Hallelujah.

Go to Hebrews 5. Hallelujah, Jesus.

Paul is defending the Hebrew believer. He is dealing with shadows and types. It is incredible.

Of course, he mentions Melchizedek in verse 10:

Called of God an high priest after the order of Melchisedec.

Then he says:

Of whom we have many things to say,
and hard to be uttered,
seeing ye are dull of hearing.

Man, I wish he could finish saying them. Everybody gets Melchizedek mixed up.

Does Paul not have a nice way of putting things?

Verse 12 says:

For when for the time ye ought to be teachers,
ye have need that one teach you again
which be the first principles of the oracles of God;
and are become such as have need of milk,
and not of strong meat.

He says, "By this time you should be teachers, but you have to be fed milk and not strong meat."
Then he defines the difference between the two:

For every one that useth milk is unskilful in the word of righteousness:
for he is a babe.

In this case, everyone who uses milk is unskillful in the word of his right standing through Jesus Christ. He is still a baby.

Then he tells you who strong meat belongs to:

But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age,
even those who by reason of use
have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.

Why would you have to discern good unless sometimes it is cloaked in evil?

We can go back and take a more basic lesson on this. Look at Hebrews 4:11:

Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest,
lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief.
For the word of God is quick, and powerful,
and sharper than any twoedged sword,
piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit,
and of the joints and marrow,
and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.
Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight:
but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of him with whom we have to do.

The Word of God is sharper than any two-edged sword. It divides soul and spirit, just like an animal could be prepared for sacrifice. It divides joints and marrow. When it drops, it discerns the intents and thoughts of the heart, and it can divide the soul over here and the pure, unadulterated truth of the Word of God over there.

He says strong meat belongs to them for a reason. Their senses are exercised to discern both good and evil. This sword can drop between the two.

My emotions say, "I am going to fail. It is no good. It is not going to work. You are sick. I cannot believe what they are saying. Everybody around me tells me I am going to fail."

But why can I refuse that? Because the Word of God divided the difference between soul and spirit, and spirit says, "He bore my sicknesses and He carried my pains." You can say what you want, but I am not going with it. I am going with truth.

By the time we get to chapter 5, Paul is saying, "You need to get off milk. As long as you stay on it, do you not understand? You are unskillful in the word of right standing. You cannot hang on to it very well."

When those Hebrew scholars come and thunder, like Paul did when he sat under Gamaliel, they can thunder at a weak little milk believer:

"How could you leave the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and the God of Moses? Who deceived you so that you would leave the only nation the unadulterated God has used? How dare you? How can you be so deceived as to follow this deceiver?"

Come on. You had better get off milk. You are unskillful in hanging on to your right standing.

Get on strong meat. Strong meat belongs to those who, by reason of using it, exercise their senses so they can discern all the good and evil they need to discern in order to be skillful in hanging on to one thing.

He did not change subjects here. The only thing I wish is that in this chapter he had said more about Melchizedek. Anybody who tries to bring tithing under the law always uses him. We just do not want to limit you to ten percent.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Hebrews 5:14 says:

But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age,
even those who by reason of use
have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil.

Therefore, because you can do those things on the meat, when you see the word "therefore," you should see what it is there for. Based on something he has already said, he is about to say this:

Therefore leaving the principles of the doctrine of Christ,
let us go on unto perfection;
not laying again the foundation of repentance from dead works,
and of faith toward God,
Of the doctrine of baptisms,
and of laying on of hands,
and of resurrection of the dead,
and of eternal judgment.
And this will we do,
if God permit.

Leave the basics of the doctrines of Christ. Go on into maturity, not laying again and again the foundation of repentance from dead works and faith toward God, the doctrines of baptisms, laying on of hands, resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment.

Paul is talking about a time period here. "This will we do, if God permit." Then he tells why:

For it is impossible for those who were once enlightened,
and have tasted of the heavenly gift,
and were made partakers of the Holy Ghost,
And have tasted the good word of God,
and the powers of the world to come,
If they shall fall away,
to renew them again unto repentance;
seeing they crucify to themselves the Son of God afresh,
and put him to an open shame.

Verse 7 gives you an explanation, if you can catch what he was talking about:

For the earth which drinketh in the rain that cometh oft upon it,
and bringeth forth herbs meet for them by whom it is dressed,
receiveth blessing from God:

But that which beareth thorns and briers
is rejected,
and is nigh unto cursing;
whose end is to be burned.

But, beloved,
we are persuaded better things of you,
and things that accompany salvation,
though we thus speak.

Before we get into this more, run ahead to Hebrews 10 and listen to how those scholars would thunder. Verse 26:

For if we sin wilfully
after that we have received the knowledge of the truth,
there remaineth no more sacrifice for sins,
But a certain fearful looking for of judgment
and fiery indignation,
which shall devour the adversaries.
He that despised Moses' law
died without mercy under two or three witnesses:
Of how much sorer punishment,
suppose ye,
shall he be thought worthy,
who hath trodden under foot the Son of God,
and hath counted the blood of the covenant,
wherewith he was sanctified,
an unholy thing,
and hath done despite unto the Spirit of grace?

That is what Paul was saying.

He says, "You are unskillful in the word of righteousness. You are unskillful in hanging on to your salvation. These men want to turn you back. They want you to deny Christ and go back over to the side of the law as God's people."

You know how strong that has been. Paul informed them there is no other sacrifice but Jesus Christ. If they turn away from Him, this is what they would be looking forward to.

So you need to get off milk so you can become skillful in hanging on to the word of right standing. Strong meat belongs to those who, by reason of using it, exercise their senses so they can discern what is good and what is evil. Then you can leave the basics behind and go on into perfection.

Taste the powers of the world to come and the Holy Ghost. After a man has tasted all those things, and Christ becomes the all-powerful, heaven-revealing, unchallenged One in his life, it is impossible for a person to deny Him and accept another form of salvation on that level, because he would have to crucify the Son of God afresh.

This means you would have to really embrace Him and understand the fullness of Him as God, and then turn around and turn your back on it. That would be impossible, because the whole revelation would have to be so removed out of you that it was fresh and brand new again and could produce a brand-new crop in you like rain from heaven on seed.

What Paul was saying is that it is impossible, because you would have to be at the point of revelation where you could not be deceived. To be renewed again, Christ would have to be crucified as though He had never existed in your revelation, and that would be impossible when you know Him like that.

But if you stay on milk, the enemy could probably succeed. He did with many. He was getting them to turn back away from Christ, deny Him, and go back under the law. That is why Paul warned them that if they did, there was nothing to look forward to but fiery indignation, because they counted the blood of the covenant an unholy thing, did despite to the grace of God, and trod the Son of God underfoot.

But because they were on milk and not meat, somebody could still get to them and bring them back over to the other side.

The ones who have tasted all of it are different. It is impossible for him to come and get you, because you would have to become equivalent to a person who had never heard.

Hallelujah.

Do you understand? As long as you are on milk, if things beat you up and you go back into the world and say, "I do not believe in that anymore," none of that would make any difference in the sense people fear. You do not know anything yet. You are just a mass of emotions and strongholds playing themselves out. He will not hold you for that.

Even when they introduce you to another god, and you are brand new in the faith and on milk, if you see your error somewhere along the way and turn back, He will take you back.

That is why Paul is so urgent: move on. Because once you have been illuminated in the strong meat and in the powers of the world to come, it becomes impossible for them to come and take you away. It would be the equivalent of never having met Him. He would have to be crucified anew, and that is impossible when you know Him like that.

There would not even be any hesitation. They could do anything they wanted. That is who the martyrs were. They could not get them to deny it. They could not get them to do it.

In Rome at one time, it was a death penalty. They would ask every Roman soldier if he was a Christian, and he had to deny or die. They did not have it easy. But they were born again, full of the power and the love of God, and they messed the world up.

Hallelujah.

I am not going to stay on this side of the basics. I am moving. I am going over to the other side. The only thing I will need Him for over there, as far as this kind of needing Him, is to understand Him more.

I need that here now.

Hallelujah.

Do you not feel safe? I do. I feel so good.

Hallelujah.